



Africa Educators' Forum

CONCEPT NOTE

**Right the Rules:
Reimagining Non-State
Actors' Role in Education**

28 OCTOBER 2022 | ASSOCIATION OF AFRICAN UNIVERSITIES AUDITORIUM





AFRICA EDUCATORS' FORUM

AFRICA LAUNCH OF THE 2022 GLOBAL EDUCATION MONITORING (GEM) YOUTH REPORT

THEME:

Right the Rules: Reimagining Non-State Actors' Role in Education

28 OCTOBER 2022 | 11:00 AM GMT

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1.0 Background

The Africa Educators' Forum is held annually to bring stakeholders in the education space and students and student leaders to address pertinent issues in the African education sector. The forum prioritizes students' voices around African educational issues and presents important thoughts about how to promote inclusive and quality Education at diverse levels. Students and student unions are important to any academic community and are worthy partners in shaping education policy. The Africa Educators' Forum presents a unique opportunity for policymakers and education leaders to draw firsthand information from the immediate beneficiaries of Education, the students.

This year's forum seeks to highlight the recommendations of the Global Education Monitoring (GEM) Youth Report and the proposals to increase inclusivity and public funding for Education while regulating the role of non-state actors.

The UNESCO GEM Report has been produced annually by UNESCO since 2002, aiming to hold the global community accountable for the commitments they made to educational progress. The report has informed national, regional, and global debates for over two decades. This year, as part of the publication of the GEM report, a youth report was written in partnership with the Global Student Forum to provide a youth perspective on the different roles and impact of non-state actors in Education.

Whether private schools promote or obstruct high-quality Education can easily be presented as the basis for any discussion on the role of non-state players in Education. However, as the youth report demonstrates, non-state actors' influence extends to many more areas of the educational system, including the provision of textbooks used in classrooms, the food served in school canteens, additional tutoring support received, and even the skills transferred on the job. The report asks young people to sign on to a call for governments to #RightTheRules, which will ensure that the commitment to provide 12 years of free primary and secondary Education and one year of pre-primary Education for everyone is not jeopardized by the presence of non-state actors.

Among other interesting revelations, the GEM report indicates that new public-private partnerships continue to blur the lines between academic and corporate environments, as evidenced by the rise of non-state actors in course delivery, academic quality assessment, technological development, research outcomes, data privacy, and scholarship and stipend provision. Also, in low- and middle-income countries, 1 in 6 families has to save, while 1 in 12 has to borrow to pay for Education. 1 in 4 countries does not regulate the number of fees charged by private schools. In low- and lower-middle-income countries, poor parents employ various strategies to cope with private school expenses, including resorting to unregistered and cheaper schools, which are likely to have poor facilities and offer a lower quality of instruction.

This year's Africa Educators' Forum will take place virtually. The forum would focus on advancing the key recommendations of the 2022 Youth GEM Report to ensure the alignment of the visions and aspirations of state and non-state actors in achieving quality access to Education for all in Africa. The forum will have a mix of state and non-state actors within the African education space.

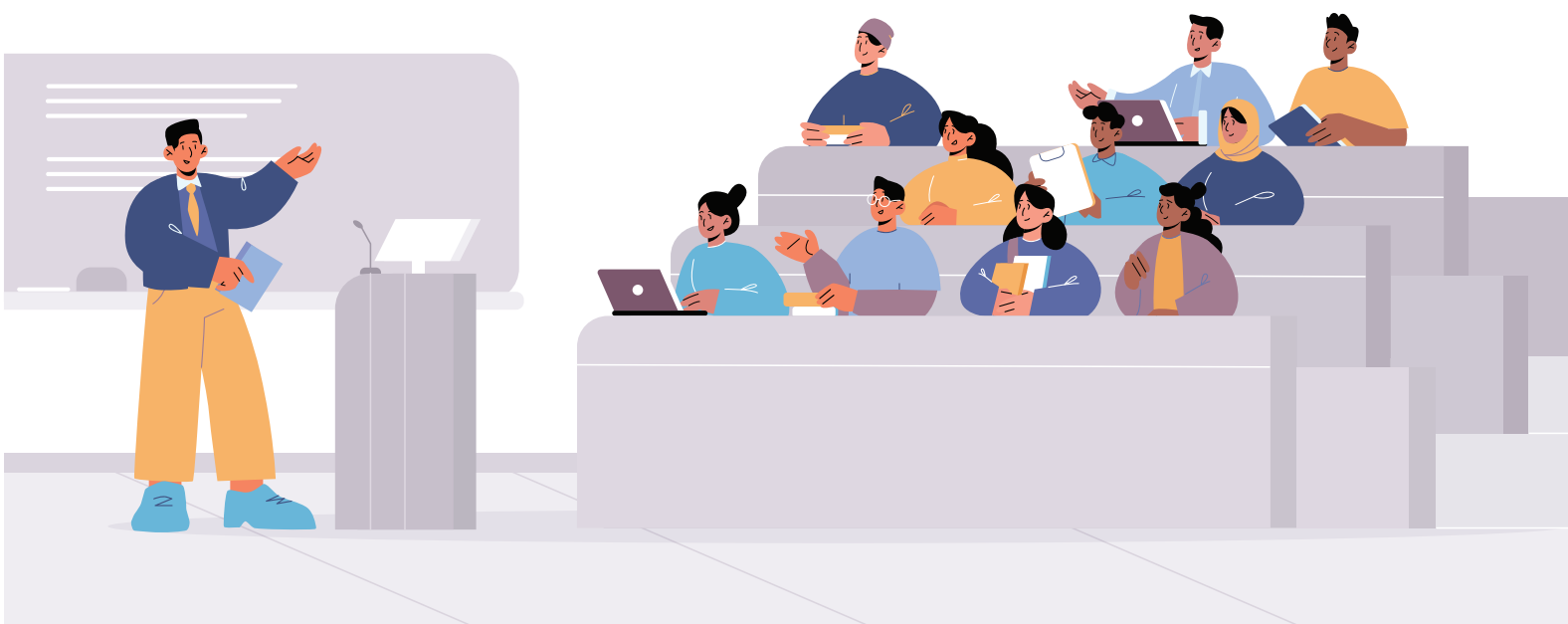
1.1 Forum objectives

The forum seeks to:

-  Assess the extent to which the financing of education favors some learners and excludes others
-  Assess whether learners receive the quality of education they are entitled to
To assess whether regulations are effective and feasible and whether they have unintended consequences that harm disadvantaged learners
-  Assess whether innovations in education are nurtured or stifled
-  Launch (Africa) the 2022 UNESCO Youth GEM Report

1.2 Sub themes

-  Education Financing: Who Chooses? Who Loses?
-  Education: A Right and Not A Privilege
-  Righting the Rules: Leveling the playing ground for all learners
-  Looking forward: How do we support innovations in education?





2.0 Event Running Order

Moderator: **Samuel Sasu Adonteng**

TIME	ACTIVITY	RESPONSIBLE
11:00 am	Ice breaker	Moderator
11:10 am	Opening remarks	AASU Secretary General
11:15 am	Special Remarks	Mr Charles Abani UN Resident Coordinator United Nations in Ghana
11:25 am	Africa Launch of the GEM Youth Report	1. Mr. Peter Kwasi Kodjie Secretary General, All-Africa Students Union 2. Mr Sebastian Berger Executive Director, Global Students Forum
11:35 am	Opening remarks	Mr. Manos Antoninis Director, GEM Report
11:45 am	Plenary Right the Rules: Reimagining Non-State Actors' role in Education	Speakers: 1. Rev. John Ntim Fordjour Deputy Min. of Education, Republic of Ghana 2. Mr Abdourahamane Diallo, UNESCO Country Director 3. Dr Dennis Sinyolo Director, Education International - Africa 4. Mr. Peter Kamalingin B.L Pan African Director, Oxfam International Moderator: GSF
12:45 pm	Breakout sessions Education Financing: Who Chooses? Who Losses? Education: A Right and Not A Privilege Righting the Rules: Leveling the playing ground for all learners Looking forward: How do we support innovations in education?	Moderators: 1. Bismark Amefianu Kudoafor 2. James Kodjie 3. Luftiyya Dean 4. Rexford Akrong



1:15pm	Open floor engagements	Rexford Akrong
1:25pm	Closing remarks	AASU Chief Technical Officer
1:30 pm	Closure	Moderator

2.1 Participation

The forum will host:

1. Leaders of educational institutions
2. Students
3. Student leaders
4. Education policy makers
5. Private education providers and actors

2.2 Forum format

The forum will take place virtually. All participants and speakers will be expected to join in via Zoom. <https://bit.ly/aef2022>

3.0 Facilitators' contact details

If you have any concerns or request for information, you can please contact any of the individuals below:

Name	Designation	Email
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